☐ beginner
☑ intermediate

会说话会跳舞的机器鸭

The Talking and Dancing Robot Duck



Story 03 November

最近，一只叫 Microduck 的机器鸭变得特别有名。它大约25厘米高，只有800克重，但不能帮人干活。你买了这个机器鸭以后，还要花时间去“教”它怎样动起来。这只“没有用的”鸭子，为什么还会这么受欢迎呢？我们一起来了解 Microduck 吧。

先说它的样子。很多机器人看起来像人一样，或者像狗。Microduck 却是一只圆头、长嘴、走路摇摆的鸭子。它走路慢、动作笨，有时还会摔倒。但是这些缺点放在鸭子身上却显得特别可爱。

机器鸭的头上有摄像头和传感器，能看清周围；有两只脚，能走路、转左转右、坐下，摔倒后还能自己爬起来；它还能用嘴巴把东西捡起来。

最重要的特点是，它把训练的机会交给了你。你可以让机器鸭跟着你学习动作。请放心，你**既不需要**会编程，**也不需要**太多的电脑的知识。你可以**通过**说话让机器鸭学习动作。你还可以把你教会它的动作上传到网上，和大家分享。

Recently, a robot duck named Microduck has become especially famous. It is about 25 centimeters tall and weighs only 800 grams, but it cannot help people do chores. After buying this robot duck, you still need to spend time "teaching" it how to move. Why is this "useless" duck still so popular? Let's get to know Microduck together.

First, let's talk about its appearance. Many robots look like humans or dogs. Microduck, however, is a duck with a round head, long beak, and waddling gait. It walks slowly, moves clumsily, and sometimes even falls down. But these shortcomings seem extra cute on a duck.

The robot duck has a camera and sensors on its head to see its surroundings clearly; it has two feet that allow it to walk, turn left and right, sit down, and climb up by itself after falling down; it can also use its beak to pick up things.

The most important feature is that it hands the training opportunity over to you. You can let the robot duck learn actions from you. Rest assured, you **neither need** programming skills **nor** much computer knowledge. You can teach the robot duck actions **through** speaking. You can also upload the actions you taught it to the internet to share with everyone.

Finally, let's talk about the price. At $399, it is much cheaper than many robots. Microduck tells us: you don't necessarily have to buy a robot that can do everything, but you can buy a clumsy, good-for-nothing robot duck and then educate it like a child.

最后说说价格。399美元，比很多机器人便宜多了。Microduck 告诉我们：你不一定要买一个什么都会的机器人，但你可以买一个笨笨的，什么都不会的机器鸭，然后像孩子一样教育它。

重点词语 (Key Vocabulary)

HSK 3 NEW HSK 3.0

中文	拼音	英文	中文	拼音	英文
最近	zuìjìn	recently / lately	有名	yǒumíng	famous / well-known
机会	jīhuì	opportunity / chance	爬	pá	to crawl / climb
然后	ránhòu	then / afterwards	自己	zìjǐ	oneself / own

HSK 4

中文	拼音	英文	中文	拼音	英文
动作	dòngzuò	action / movement	通过	tōngguò	through / by means of
缺点	quēdiǎn	shortcoming / flaw	周围	zhōuwéi	surroundings / around
教育	jiàoyù	to educate / education	笨	bèn	clumsy / stupid

HSK 5

中文	拼音	英文	中文	拼音	英文
机器	jīqì	machine / mechanism	厘米	límǐ	centimeter
捡	jiǎn	to pick up / collect	摔倒	shuāidǎo	to fall down / trip

语言点 (Language Points)

既.....也不..... (neither... nor... / not only... but also... - HSK4-07)

关联词，表示并列关联系，说明同时具有或不具有两种情况。 Conjunction used to link parallel elements, indicating that two conditions exist or do not exist simultaneously.

> 例①：你既不需要会编程，也不需要太多的电脑的知识。
> *You neither need programming skills nor much computer knowledge.*
> 例②：这种水果既不好看也不好吃。
> *This kind of fruit is neither good-looking nor tasty.*

通过 (through / by means of - HSK4-09)
介词，表示以某种手段、方式或途径达到目的。 Preposition indicating reaching an end by means of a certain method or channel.

> 例①：你可以通过说话让机器鸭学习动作。
> *You can teach the robot duck actions through speaking.*
> 例②：我们可以通过听慢音乐放松。
> *We can relax by listening to slow music.*

练习 (Exercises)

1）Microduck 为什么不能像普通机器人一样帮人干活？

- ☐ A. 因为它太重了
- ☐ B. 因为它没有摄像头和传感器
- ☐ C. 因为它只能在网上活动
- ☐ D. 因为它是一只需要人们训练的机器鸭

2）Microduck 为什么看起来特别可爱？

- ☐ A. 因为它走路很快，动作很灵活
- ☐ B. 因为它走路摇摆，动作笨笨的，有时还会摔倒
- ☐ C. 因为它看起来像一个小孩子
- ☐ D. 因为它能做很多复杂的工作

3）人们怎样教 Microduck 学习动作？

- ☐ A. 通过说话让它学习，不需要会编程
- ☐ B. 必须使用专业的电脑软件
- ☐ C. 请机器鸭的设计师亲自训练
- ☐ D. 把它送到专门的机器人学校

简答题 (Short Answer)

4）Microduck 有哪些身体和动作方面的功能？

5）人们为什么可以把教会 Microduck 的动作上传到网上？

参考答案 (Answer Key)：

1. D　　2. B　　3. A
4. 它有摄像头和传感器，能看清周围；能走路、转弯、坐下、自己爬起来，还能用嘴捡东西。
5. 因为这样可以和大家分享自己教会机器鸭的动作。